Keimyung University · First-round faculty interview

Digital History Today and Its Future Directions

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Open the presentation



littlekg87.github.io/lecture/2026_Keimyung/ ↗

International and Korean projects

At what scale is digital history being practiced?

International

Holocaust archives portal

Ten founding countries launched EHRI-ERIC to support research across dispersed collections.

Letters from early modern Europe

Stanford researchers traced intellectual exchange through correspondence and travel records.

Korea

East Asia’s carbon regime

Eunsung Cho’s Sogang team uses GIS to trace coal production, trade and use. NRF institute grant, six years.

Relief supplies in the port city of Busan

Bongseok Han’s Pukyong team maps Cold War relief flows from distribution records. AKS regional institute grant, three years.

EHRI-ERIC ↗ · Mapping the Republic of Letters · KADH / NRF · KADH / AKS

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Chapter 1

Digital History Today

I The field today

What does a chronology leave out?

Digitization › Database editing › Digital analysis › AI tools

Today, all four activities coexist

Rapid technological change

AI-assisted transcription and scholarly collation can be part of the same edition.

Specialized research roles

Source editors, tool builders and historians can produce different kinds of scholarship from the same records.

김근하 (2026),『역사논총』53, 378–388.

Two research purposes, two kinds of output



Building research environments

What can scholars now find and compare?

Reconstructing boundaries

Spatial data with sources and location evidence



Investigating historical questions

What historical question can the evidence answer?

Explaining regional markets

A historical explanation grounded in spatial data

Around 60 studies, with emphasis on premodern sources in literary Chinese · 김근하 (2026), 380–389.

How are digital research environments built?

Databases
Entities and sources

Spatial data
Historical GIS

Algorithms and AI
Source processing

How can scholars compare conflicting register entries?

Linking each graduate to registers and sources makes omissions and variant entries traceable.

Lee Jae-ok (2021), on an ontology for collating civil-service examination registers, 인문콘텐츠 60.

Database compilation remains central. Improving its speed and accuracy has become a research question in its own right.

How does digital analysis refine historical explanations?

Space	Relations	Language	Distribution	Synthesis
HGIS	Networks	Text mining	Statistics	Mixed methods

Did disparities in military obligations arise within or between provinces?

GIS mapped the records of 334 counties. Decomposing the Theil index showed that 61% of inequality arose between counties within the same province.

Kun-ha Kim and Donghyun Woo (2025), "Measuring Equity in Early Joseon Military Service," 역사와 현실 137. ↗

Comparison across regions and periods reveals the reach and limits of existing explanations, and patterns hidden in individual cases.

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Chapter 2

Future Directions for Digital History

II Future directions

Directions for collaborative research



Building research environments

Build research infrastructure across countries and disciplines.



Investigating historical questions

Develop shared research agendas for HK, BK and research institute grants.

II Future directions

From undergraduate source work to graduate research

Undergraduate foundations

Structuring sources

Introduction to Digital History · Understanding Historical Data · Building Historical Databases

Students use basic coding to build a source-linked database.

Advanced undergraduate

Applying methods

GIS and Historical Geography · Analyzing Historical Sources with Text Mining

Students investigate a historical question using GIS or text mining.

Graduate seminar

Designing research

Research Design in Digital History

Students build a shared dataset and develop individual thesis projects.

Digital history extends the historian's craft.

Digital methods let us test an explanation drawn from many sources against individual records, across a wider field of evidence.